

Verborum Marketplace

What is built, and what is still needed to finish it · status as of 27 September 2026 · branch `feature/ms-marketplace-scaffold` (12 commits)

In one sentence: the marketplace **backend is complete** - every task in roadmap Phase 4 is done, reviewed, security-audited and verified against the running system - but **no user can use it yet**, because the client apps (Android, iOS, web) have not built the marketplace screens, and the web app additionally needs the API gateway (Phase 5).

What the marketplace does

- A user marks one of their dictionaries **public**; within about a second it appears as a **listing** in the marketplace.
- Other users **browse** listings - newest, most popular, by language pair, or by publisher - 20 per page by default.
- A user **imports** a listing: it is added to their **vault** as a reference, and they can open and read the dictionary and its words (read-only, always the owner's latest version).
- If the owner makes it private or deletes it, it disappears from the marketplace and becomes unreadable for importers.

1. What has been implemented

All ten Phase 4 tasks, plus one fix found along the way. Each was code-reviewed before commit; the tasks that exposed endpoints or changed access rules were also security-audited.

Task	What	In plain words
P4-01	ms_marketplace service created	New microservice on port 8087 with its own database. Login (Keycloak token) required on every endpoint from the first commit.
P4-02	Listings table	One row per public dictionary: name, languages, publisher, import count, publish date, and the timestamp used to ignore out-of-date updates.
P4-03	Listings kept up to date	ms_dictionary sends an event when a dictionary goes public or a public one is renamed; the marketplace applies it within a second. A nightly snapshot of all public dictionaries repairs anything a lost event left wrong.
P4-04	Going private	The listing is hidden , not deleted, so late or out-of-order events cannot bring back a dictionary its owner just made private.
P4-05	Deletions	A deleted dictionary's listing is hidden; a deleted user's listings (and import records) are removed immediately.
P4-06	Browse API	Four paginated endpoints: newest, popular, by language pair, by publisher. Listings show the publisher id so users can see "more from this publisher".
P4-07	Import	Import endpoint; the import count counts distinct users (no inflating by repeated taps); importing your own dictionary is refused; ms_user adds the vault entry.
P4-08	Dictionary tags	Built earlier (July) - tags on dictionaries, readable by the marketplace.
P4-09	Input validation fixed	Language-code and id validation had never actually run in any service. Fixed in all three; invalid input is now rejected with a clear error.

Task	What	In plain words
P4-10	Public dictionaries readable	Anyone logged in can read a public dictionary and its words, so an imported dictionary can actually be opened. Private ones stay hidden; only the owner can change anything. Another user's learning progress on words is never shown.
Fix	Word save message	"Saved successfully into dictionary" now names the dictionary instead of echoing every saved word back.

Quality and verification

Check	Result
Automated tests	233 passing across the three services (ms_dictionary 110, ms_user 44, ms_marketplace 79) - including tests that a private dictionary never leaks and that another user can never write to your data.
Code reviews	Every commit reviewed against the project conventions; all findings fixed before committing.
Security audits	Marketplace API, import endpoint and the public-read change audited separately - no blocking or warning findings.
Live verification	Every task exercised against the real running stack (database, message broker, Keycloak), including two-user tests and deliberately broken data to prove the nightly repair works. Nothing ended up in the error queue.
Documentation	Roadmap, architecture notes, security contract and the client-facing docs updated; a dedicated guide for the client apps (marketplace-client-guide.md) written.

2. Decisions made along the way

These shape how the marketplace behaves; each was agreed before it was built.

Decision	Chosen	Why
How listings stay correct	Events + a nightly full snapshot	Fast updates normally; the snapshot is a safety net for lost events. The marketplace never calls ms_dictionary while serving users, so it keeps working if that service is down.
What import means	A reference, not a copy	The importer always sees the owner's current version. Trade-off: it disappears if the owner unpublishes it.
Popularity	Distinct importers	One user importing 100 times counts once.
Going private	Hide the listing, keep the row	Prevents a private dictionary from being re-listed by stale data.
Publisher on listings	Shown as an id	Enables "more from this publisher". Checked: the id grants no access anywhere. A display name comes later.
Paging format	Our own compact format	Stable for the three client apps; Spring's default format changes between versions.
Language codes	Stored uppercase in the marketplace	So filtering by EN/de/En all match.
Own dictionary	Import refused (error 400)	The apps hide the button; stops self-promotion.
Learning progress	Hidden from other users	Progress on words is personal; importers keep their own progress on their device.

3. What still needs to be done

Grouped by what it blocks. **Roadmap** = already recorded as a task; **New** = found or suggested in this report and not yet in the roadmap.

A. Required before users can use the marketplace

#	Item	Where	Status
A1	Send the client heads-up message (ready to send, in the client guide section 0) - several backend changes will otherwise look like unexplained errors in the apps.	People	Roadmap P3-03a - drafted
A2	Build the marketplace in the Android app: browse, filters, publisher page, import, vault, read-only view of imported dictionaries, local progress for imported words.	Android repo	New (client work)
A3	Build the same in the iOS + web app (shared Compose Multiplatform code).	KMP repo	New (client work)
A4	API gateway with CORS - without it a browser cannot call the backend at all, so the web app cannot use the marketplace . Mobile apps are not affected.	Backend	Roadmap P5-01..P5-03

B. Required before a public launch

#	Item	Where	Status
B1	Rate limiting and HTTPS at the edge (the marketplace has no request limits today).	Backend	Roadmap P5-04
B2	Bot protection (reCAPTCHA) on sign-up.	Keycloak	Roadmap BL-02
B3	Rotate all development secrets; remove the test-only login client.	Keycloak / config	Roadmap BL-03

C. Product features not built yet

#	Item	Notes	Status
C1	Publisher display names ("by Anna" instead of an id).	Needs ms_user to announce profile names.	Roadmap BL-04
C2	Clean up vault entries whose dictionary became private or was deleted.	Today the apps must detect and offer "Remove" themselves.	New
C3	Search by name or by tag.	Tags exist but cannot be searched in the marketplace.	New
C4	Ratings and view counts.	Deliberately left out until designed (scale, one per user).	New - needs design
C5	"Make my own editable copy" of an imported dictionary.	Imports are read-only references.	New - optional
C6	Publisher sees who imported / notification on import.	Not requested yet.	New - optional

D. Hardening and operations (not blocking, worth scheduling)

#	Item	When it matters	Status
D1	Lock the nightly snapshot so only one server sends it (ShedLock).	When ms_dictionary runs on more than one server.	Noted in P4-03
D2	Split the snapshot into chunks.	Hundreds of thousands of public dictionaries.	Noted in P4-03
D3	Turn the rare same-user double-import error (500) into a normal success.	Only on simultaneous double taps; the apps also guard against it.	New
D4	Automated end-to-end tests for the event flow (today: unit tests + manual live runs).	Before the team grows / CI.	New
D5	Database indexes tuned for "visible listings only" queries.	Once listings number in the thousands.	Noted in P4-06
D6	Language codes are still stored as sent in ms_dictionary (only the marketplace uppercases).	Cosmetic consistency across services.	New - optional

4. Suggested order

1. **Now:** send the client heads-up (A1) and merge this branch.
2. **Next backend work:** Phase 5 - the API gateway with CORS (A4), then rate limiting and HTTPS (B1). This unblocks the web app.
3. **In parallel, client work:** Android marketplace screens (A2), then iOS/web (A3), following docs/integration/marketplace-client-guide.md.
4. **When the client teams build the marketplace screens:** publisher names (C1) and vault clean-up (C2) - both noticeably improve what users see.
5. **Before a public launch:** B2 and B3.
6. **Later, by demand:** search (C3), ratings (C4), copies (C5), and the hardening items in D as scale requires.

Sources: docs/agent/roadmap.md (Phase 4 entries, backlog BL-01..BL-04, Phase 5), docs/integration/marketplace-client-guide.md, and the live verification runs recorded in each task.